Farouk Uthman

Toronto, ON | 647-787-7972 | faroukuthman15@gmail.com | LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/farouk-uthman/ | Github: https://github.com/Faroukuthman

EDUCATION

Universiti Sains Islam Malaysia **Nilai, Negeri Sembilan**

B.Sc. Computer Science (Information Security & Assurance)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Empirical Training **Toronto, ON**

Cybersecurity Analyst (Apprenticeship) *Mar 2026 – Present*

- Operated within a SOC-style monitoring environment aligned with enterprise detection engineering practices, triaging 300–600 SIEM alerts monthly across phishing, brute-force, and malware detections using Splunk & Microsoft Sentinel.
- Investigated Active Directory/Entra ID authentication events, analyzing Kerberos/NTLM patterns, privileged account activity, and group membership changes to detect credential abuse and lateral movement.
- Reduced Mean Time to Investigate (MTTI) by ~30% by refining SIEM correlation logic, adding trusted IP exclusions, and streamlining log correlation across Windows, Linux, and cloud telemetry.
- Supported SOAR workflows using Microsoft Sentinel Playbooks (Logic Apps) to automate repetitive tasks such as IOC extraction and alert enrichment, improving triage efficiency by ~25%.
- Developed and tuned 20+ detection rules mapped to MITRE ATT&CK tactics (Initial Access, Persistence, Privilege Escalation), specifically targeting T1059 (PowerShell) and T1098 (Account Manipulation).
- Managed the full incident lifecycle (Detection → Remediation → Closure) using structured ServiceNow/Jira workflows, maintaining audit-ready documentation and high-quality shift handoff reports.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

Microsoft Sentinel Cloud Threat Hunting Lab

- Designed an enterprise-grade SOC simulation integrating AWS CloudTrail, Microsoft Entra ID, and Defender for Endpoint into Microsoft Sentinel for centralized visibility.
- Investigated cloud-native threats, including AWS IAM role assumptions, access key creation, and Azure risky sign-ins, correlating API activity with endpoint telemetry to detect multi-stage attack patterns.
- Automated alert prioritization by integrating threat intelligence feeds to automatically enrich SIEM alerts with IP reputation and geolocation data.

Security Onion & Network Detection Lab

- Monitored segmented network traffic using Security Onion, Suricata IDS, and Wireshark; detected beaconing, DNS anomalies, and reconnaissance attempts across DMZ and internal zones.
- Analyzed endpoint telemetry, including process trees and registry modifications to build end-to-end attack timelines, correlating network alerts with host-based findings.

Vulnerability Management & Risk Remediation Lab

- Orchestrated vulnerability scans for 20+ systems using Tenable.io and Nessus, prioritizing remediation based on CVSS severity, exploitability, and asset criticality.
- Reduced attack surface by 60%+ through patch validation and firewall hardening, tracking remediation status via custom risk dashboards.

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+

TECHNICAL SKILLS

SIEM & SOC Tools: Splunk, Microsoft Sentinel, Wazuh, Elastic Stack
Threat Detection: MITRE ATT&CK, Cyber Kill Chain, IOC analysis, threat hunting
Cloud Security: AWS (CloudTrail, IAM, GuardDuty), Azure, Entra ID, Defender for Cloud
Endpoint Security: Defender for Endpoint, Tanium, Sysmon, malware analysis
Networking: Wireshark, Suricata IDS, Security Onion, DNS/firewall logs, Nmap
Scripting & Automation: PowerShell, Bash, KQL, Sentinel automation rules, Logic Apps (SOAR concepts)
Vulnerability Mgmt: Tenable.io, Nessus, CVSS scoring, CVE analysis, patch validation
Workflow Tools: ServiceNow (simulated), Jira (simulated), incident ticketing, escalation workflows